IELTS SPEAKING • TOPIC 14

RESTAURANTS AND EATING OUT

Natural collocations • Advanced grammar structures • Sample answer

PART 1 • QUESTIONS

- Do you often eat out?
- What kind of restaurants do you like?
- Do you prefer eating at home or in a restaurant?

PART 2 • CUE CARD

Describe a restaurant you like.

You should say:

- where it is
- what food it serves
- who you go with
- why you like it

PART 3 • QUESTIONS

- Why is fast food so popular?
- Are people's eating habits changing?
- Is home cooking healthier than eating out?

50	12	62	124
collocations	structures	Band 8 stories	your sentences

START HERE

One plan for every “restaurants and eating out” card

- A restaurant you like
- A meal you enjoyed with your family
- A special meal you had in a restaurant
- A café or coffee shop you like to visit
- A traditional dish from your country
- A time you ate something new
- A place where you often meet friends for food
- A meal you cooked for someone

Where it is → **What** food it serves → **Who** you go with → **Why** you like it

HOW TO READ EACH CARD

Tarjima + definition — o‘zbekcha ma’nosi va oddiy inglizcha izohi.

Band 8 story — iborani ro‘yxat emas, mini hikoya ichida ishlatish namunasi.

≈ Yaqin iboralar — shu ma’noga yaqin yana 2 ta natural ibora.

Qachon ishlatiladi — qaysi vaziyatda va qanday grammatika bilan.

Namuna gap — bitta tayyor gap. Keyin o‘zingiz 2 ta gap yozing.

Speaking ball — shu ibora gapirishda qanchalik foydali (10 dan).

10 / 10	Signature ibora: Band 8 ni ko‘rsatadi, ko‘p topiclarda ishlaydi.
8–9	Kuchli va moslashuvchan: tabiiy eshitiladi, ball oshiradi.
6–7	Foydali va ishonchli: asos sifatida yaxshi.
4–5	Vaziyatga bog‘liq yoki oddiyroq: faqat mos kelganda ishlating.

Describing the restaurant and its atmosphere

COLLOCATIONS 1 / 5

1 hidden gem

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

yashirin dur, kam odam biladigan ajoyib joy • *a great place that few people know about*

BAND 8 STORY

My cousin took me to a tiny restaurant behind Chorsu Bazaar, and I honestly thought it was a dead end at first. It turned out to be a **hidden gem**, and now I go back whenever I crave proper lagman.

≈ **best-kept secret** — hamma bilavermaydigan sara joy

≈ **off the beaten track** — odamlar kam boradigan joyda

Qachon ishlatiladi: Kam tanilgan, lekin juda yaxshi joyni maqtashda ishlating: a real hidden gem. Part 1 va Part 2 da restoran, kafe yoki sayohat joyi uchun mos.

Namuna gap: That little chaikhana is a real **hidden gem**, so I'd hate to see it become too popular.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 family-run

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

oilaviy yuritiladigan • *owned and managed by members of one family*

BAND 8 STORY

The place is **family-run**, so the grandmother cooks while her sons wait on tables. You can feel the care in every dish, and they always ask how your day was, which makes you feel like a guest at home.

≈ **owner-operated** — egasi o'zi boshqaradigan

≈ **a mom-and-pop place** — kichik oilaviy do'kon yoki kafe

Qachon ishlatiladi: Restoranning samimiy, ishonchli ekanini ko'rsatadi. Sifat sifatida ishlatiladi: a family-run restaurant/business. Part 2 da yaxshi detal.

Namuna gap: I prefer **family-run** restaurants because the food tastes like it was made with love rather than on a production line.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 laid-back atmosphere

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

erkin, shinam va bosiq muhit • *a relaxed, informal feeling where nobody is in a hurry*

BAND 8 STORY

The café has a really **laid-back atmosphere**, with low sofas and soft music. After a stressful week of mock tests, I could finally switch off there and chat with my friends for hours.

≈ **relaxed vibe** — tinch, erkin kayfiyat

≈ **easy-going feel** — bemalol, shinam muhit

Qachon ishlatiladi: Joyning muhitini tasvirlashning tabiiy usuli: a laid-back atmosphere/vibe. Part 2 da 'why I like it' qismida juda foydali. 'Laid-back' norasmiy uslub.

Namuna gap: What I like about the place is its **laid-back atmosphere**, which makes it perfect for long conversations.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 always packed

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

doim gavjum, tiqilinch • *completely full of people, with no empty tables*

BAND 8 STORY

On Fridays the restaurant is **always packed**, and we often wait twenty minutes for a table. Honestly, that's a good sign, because locals wouldn't queue for food that wasn't worth it.

≈ **jam-packed** — tiqilib ketgan

≈ **bursting at the seams** — odamdan to'lib-toshgan

Qachon ishlatiladi: Mashhur, gavjum joy haqida gapirishda ishlating: be packed (with people). Ko'pincha 'at weekends' bilan keladi. 'Always' o'rniga 'usually' ham mumkin.

Namuna gap: The place is **always packed** at lunchtime, so I try to arrive before noon.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 within walking distance

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

piyoda boradigan masofada • *close enough to reach on foot*

BAND 8 STORY

I chose this restaurant because it's **within walking distance** of my university. After lectures, we just stroll over, grab a table by the window and forget about the traffic jam outside.

≈ **a stone's throw from** — bir tosh otimlik joyda

≈ **just around the corner** — aynan burchak orqasida

Qachon ishlatiladi: Joylashuvni aytishda: within walking distance of + joy. 'In walking distance' demang, to'g'risi 'within'. Part 2 'where it is' uchun juda mos.

Namuna gap: Living **within walking distance** of good restaurants is one of the biggest perks of city life.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 buzzing with life

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

jonlanib turgan, shov-shuvli va quvnoq • *full of energy, noise and activity*

BAND 8 STORY

When we walked in on Saturday night, the whole place was **buzzing with life**. Waiters were rushing between tables, families were laughing over big plates of plov, and I instantly felt I was in the right place.

≈ **lively** — quvnoq, jonli

≈ **full of energy** — energiyaga to'la

Qachon ishlatiladi: Gavjum, quvnoq muhitni tasvirlash uchun: be buzzing with + noun/with life. Ijobiy ma'noda. Salbiy bo'lsa 'overcrowded, deafening' deng.

Namuna gap: The bazaar food court is **buzzing with life** every evening, which is exactly why I love it.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

7 a cosy little place

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

shinam kichkina joy • *a small, warm and comfortable restaurant or café*

BAND 8 STORY

We found **a cosy little place** near Amir Temur Square with only eight tables and wooden walls. It felt so snug that we ended up staying two hours after finishing our tea.

≈ **a snug spot** — kichkina, shinam joy

≈ **a charming café** — jozibali kafe

Qachon ishlatiladi: Kichik, issiq va qulay joyni maqtashda ishlating. 'Little' bu yerda hissiy iliqlikni bildiradi. 'Small' dan ko'ra ancha tabiiy va do'stona.

Namuna gap: I'm drawn to **a cosy little place** more than a flashy restaurant, since it feels more personal.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 tastefully decorated

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

did bilan bezatilgan • *decorated in a stylish way that looks elegant, not too much*

BAND 8 STORY

The dining room is **tastefully decorated**, with hand-painted ceramics from Rishtan on the walls. It's the sort of detail that makes an ordinary dinner feel like a small celebration.

≈ **beautifully furnished** — chiroyli jihozlangan

≈ **elegantly designed** — nafis ishlangan

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ichki bezakni tasvirlashda: be tastefully decorated/furnished. Rasmiyroq va yuqori darajadagi so'z; Part 2 da bir marta ishlatsangiz yetarli.

Namuna gap: The restaurant is **tastefully decorated**, so even the plainest meal feels special.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 dimly lit

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

xira yoritilgan • *with soft, low light*

BAND 8 STORY

The restaurant is **dimly lit**, with candles on every table, so the atmosphere is romantic and quiet. I took my parents there for their anniversary, and my mum said she felt like she was in a film.

≈ **softly lit** — yumshoq yoritilgan

≈ **candlelit** — shamlar yorug'ligida

Qachon ishlatiladi: Romantik yoki tinch muhitni tasvirlaydi: a dimly lit room/restaurant. Salbiy ma'noda ham bo'lishi mumkin (juda qorong'i), shuning uchun kontekstga e'tibor bering.

Namuna gap: The dining room was **dimly lit**, which suited the quiet mood of our evening.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 outdoor seating

5/10
SPEAKING BALL

ochiq havodagi o‘tirish joylari • *tables and chairs outside a restaurant*

BAND 8 STORY

In summer, I always ask for **outdoor seating**, because eating under the vine leaves in the courtyard feels magical. The air smells of grilled kebabs, and the evening breeze is the best air conditioner.

≈ **a terrace** — terrasa

≈ **a courtyard area** — hovli qismi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yozda restoran tanlash sababini aytishda: have/offer outdoor seating. Terrace yoki courtyard ham ishlatiladi. Part 1 da ‘What kind of restaurants do you like?’ ga yaxshi javob.

Namuna gap: Restaurants with **outdoor seating** are very popular in Tashkent once the weather warms up.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 signature dish

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

restoranning o‘ziga xos, mashhur taomi • *the special meal a restaurant is best known for*

BAND 8 STORY
Their **signature dish** is a lamb manti with a spoonful of sour cream, and people come from across the city for it. The first time I tried it, I closed my eyes for a second just to enjoy the flavour.

≈ **speciality of the house** — restoran maxsus taomi

≈ **house special** — uyning maxsus taomi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Restoran taomlarini tasvirlashda eng kerakli ibora. Part 2 da ‘what food it serves’ bandiga ayniqsa mos: Their signature dish is ...

Namuna gap: The restaurant’s **signature dish** is slow-cooked lamb, and it never disappoints.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 generous portions

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

katta, to‘yimli porsiyalar • *large amounts of food on each plate*

BAND 8 STORY
The best thing about the place is the **generous portions**. I once ordered a single plate of plov and had to take half home, which made my mum very happy the next day.

≈ **hearty servings** — to‘yimli porsiyalar

≈ **big helpings** — katta ulush

Qachon ishlatiladi: Taom miqdorini maqtashda: generous/large/small portions. ‘Big portions’ ham mumkin, lekin ‘generous’ ancha chiroyli. Salbiy bo‘lsa ‘tiny portions’ deng.

Namuna gap: Prices are fair and the **generous portions** mean nobody leaves hungry.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

13 cooked to perfection

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

mukammal pishirilgan • *prepared exactly right, not too much or too little*

BAND 8 STORY
The steak was **cooked to perfection**: crispy outside and juicy inside. I’d been anxious about the price, but after the first bite I knew it was money well spent.

≈ **perfectly cooked** — ajoyib pishgan

≈ **done just right** — aynan kerakli darajada pishgan

Qachon ishlatiladi: Go‘sht, baliq yoki guruch kabi taomlar uchun: be cooked to perfection. Taomni maqtashda eng kuchli iboralardan biri; Part 2 da juda mos.

Namuna gap: The kebabs were **cooked to perfection**, with a smoky flavour I still remember.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

14 melt in your mouth

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

og‘izda erib ketadigan • *so soft and tender that it almost dissolves when you eat it*

BAND 8 STORY

Their samsa is so flaky that it practically **melts in your mouth**. My little brother, who normally hates vegetables, finished three pieces and then asked whether we could come again next week.

≈ **be incredibly tender** — juda yumshoq bo‘lmoq

≈ **be soft as butter** — yog‘dek yumshoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yumshoq go‘sht, shirinlik yoki xamirli taomlarni tasvirlaydi: It melts in your mouth. Odatda fe‘l shaklida ishlatiladi (melts / melted).

Namuna gap: The dessert **melted in my mouth**, and it was worth every calorie.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

15 piping hot

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

juda issiq, qaynoq • *very hot, just taken from the fire or oven*

BAND 8 STORY

The soup arrived **piping hot**, with steam rising from the bowl. It was a freezing January evening, so that first spoonful felt like a warm hug after the walk through the snow.

≈ **freshly served** — endigina keltirilgan

≈ **steaming hot** — bug‘i chiqib turgan

Qachon ishlatiladi: Issiq taomni tasvirlash uchun: piping hot soup/bread/tea. Odatda sovuq kunlarda yoki yangi pishgan taom haqida gapirganda juda tabiiy.

Namuna gap: Nothing beats **piping hot** bread straight from the tandoor on a cold morning.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

16 mouth-watering

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

og‘iz suvini keltiradigan • *looking or smelling so good that it makes you want to eat it*

BAND 8 STORY

As soon as I stepped inside, the smell of grilled meat was absolutely **mouth-watering**. We hadn’t eaten since breakfast, so I could barely sit still while we waited for the food.

≈ **appetising** — ishtahani ochadigan

≈ **delectable** — juda mazali

Qachon ishlatiladi: Taom ko‘rinishi yoki hidini maqtash uchun sifat sifatida: a mouth-watering smell/dish. Juda mashhur, shuning uchun ‘delicious’ o‘rniga ishlatish yaxshi.

Namuna gap: The photos of the dishes looked **mouth-watering**, so I booked straight away.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

17 packed with flavour

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

ta’m va xushbo‘ylikka boy • *full of strong, pleasant taste*

BAND 8 STORY

The dumplings were small but **packed with flavour**, thanks to the herbs and spices inside. I’m not a big eater, yet I ordered a second round without even thinking about it.

≈ **bursting with flavour** — ta‘mga to‘la

≈ **rich in flavour** — mazasi boy

Qachon ishlatiladi: Taomning ta’mi to‘yingan bo‘lishini ifodalaydi: be packed with + noun. ‘Flavour’ o‘rniga ‘protein’, ‘vitamins’ desa ham bo‘ladi (sog‘lom ovqat haqida).

Namuna gap: Even a simple salad can be **packed with flavour** if the vegetables are fresh.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

18 locally sourced

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

mahalliy ishlab chiqaruvchidan olingan • *bought from farms or producers in the same area*

BAND 8 STORY

The owner told us that everything on the menu is **locally sourced**, from the lamb to the tomatoes. You can really taste the difference, and it’s nice to know your money supports local farmers.

≈ **farm-to-table** — fermadan to‘g‘ri stolga

≈ **homegrown** — o‘zimizda yetishtirilgan

Qachon ishlatiladi: Sifatli, tabiiy mahsulotlarni maqtash uchun: locally sourced ingredients/produce. Sog‘lom ovqat va Part 3 (yeyish odatlari) uchun ham mos.

Namuna gap: I’m willing to pay more for **locally sourced** ingredients because they’re fresher.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

19 authentic cuisine

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

haqiqiy, an’anaviy oshxona • *traditional food made in the real, original way*

BAND 8 STORY

If you want to try **authentic cuisine**, go to a Khorezm restaurant and order shivit oshi. The chef is from Urgench, and he makes everything exactly like his grandmother did, even the green noodles.

≈ **traditional dishes** — an’anaviy taomlar

≈ **real local food** — haqiqiy mahalliy taomlar

Qachon ishlatiladi: Milliy yoki an’anaviy taomlarni tasvirlashda: authentic cuisine/food. ‘Real food’ dan ko‘ra ancha tabiiy; chet elliklarga o‘zbek taomini tushuntirganda juda foydali.

Namuna gap: Tourists often look for **authentic cuisine**, not just the dishes found on every street.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

20 freshly prepared

6/10
SPEAKING BALL

yangi tayyorlangan • *made just before serving, not kept for a long time*

BAND 8 STORY

Everything at this café is **freshly prepared**, so the food can take a bit longer, but it's worth it. I once watched the chef roll out the dough right in front of us, and that made the lagman taste even better.

≈ **made from scratch** — noldan tayyorlangan

≈ **made to order** — buyurtma bo'yicha tayyorlangan

Qachon ishlatiladi: Taom yangiligini va sifatini ta'kidlash uchun: freshly prepared/baked/squeezed. Ko'pincha 'ready-made' (tayyor) ga qarama-qarshi qo'yiladi.

Namuna gap: I trust a restaurant more when its dishes are **freshly prepared** in an open kitchen.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

21 book a table

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

stol band qilmoq • *to reserve a table in advance*

BAND 8 STORY
For my sister's birthday, I **booked a table** two weeks ahead, because the restaurant gets full on weekends. When we arrived, our table by the fountain was ready, and I felt very relieved.

≈ **make a reservation** — bron qilmoq

≈ **reserve a table** — stol oldindan buyurtma qilmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO
(fe'l) chipta yoki xonani oldindan band qilmoq — We **booked** a hotel room months before the wedding season started.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Restoranga borishdan oldingi odatiy fe'l: book a table for + son + at + vaqt. Amerikacha 'make a reservation' ham tabiiy. Part 1 da keng qo'llanadi.

Namuna gap: It's wise to **book a table** in advance if you're going out on a Friday night.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

22 place an order

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

buyurtma bermoq • *to ask for food or drink from the waiter or an app*

BAND 8 STORY
We were so hungry that we **placed an order** almost as soon as we sat down. Within ten minutes, a huge dish of plov arrived, and we ate in complete silence for a minute.

≈ **order** — buyurtma qilmoq

≈ **put in an order** — buyurtmani yubormoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Rasmiyroq ibora: place an order (at/with/through). Ilova orqali ovqat buyurtma qilishda ayniqsa mos. Oddiy suhbatda 'order' ham yetarli.

Namuna gap: I usually **place an order** through an app when I can't be bothered to cook.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

23 attentive service

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

e'tiborli xizmat • *staff who notice what customers need and help quickly*

BAND 8 STORY
What impressed me most was the **attentive service**. The waiter noticed my glass was empty before I did and even remembered that my friend didn't eat spicy food.

≈ **courteous staff** — xushmuomala xodimlar

≈ **prompt service** — tezkor xizmat

Qachon ishlatiladi: Xizmat sifatini maqtashda: attentive/friendly/prompt service. Part 2 da 'why I like it' uchun foydali; yomon xizmat uchun 'slow, inattentive service'.

Namuna gap: **Attentive service** can turn an ordinary meal into a memorable experience.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

24 split the bill

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

hisobni teng bo‘lib to‘lamoq • *to divide the cost of a meal between everyone*

BAND 8 STORY

After we finished the meal, we decided to **split the bill** evenly, since none of us wanted to argue over who ate more. It’s a small habit, but it keeps friendships comfortable.

≈ **go Dutch** — har kim o‘zi uchun to‘lamoq

≈ **share the cost** — xarajatni bo‘lishmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

(fe’l) bo‘linmoq, ajralmoq — The group **split** up after dinner and went their separate ways.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Do‘stlar bilan ovqatlanish haqida: split the bill (equally/evenly/three ways). ‘Go Dutch’ norasmiyroq. Part 2 da ‘who you go with’ da yaxshi detal.

Namuna gap: Among students, it’s common to **split the bill** when you eat out.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

25 pick up the tab

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

hisobni to‘lab qo‘ymoq • *to pay the bill for everyone*

BAND 8 STORY

When my uncle visited from Samarkand, he insisted on **picking up the tab**, even though I protested. In Uzbek culture, the host paying is a point of honour, so I eventually gave in with a smile.

≈ **foot the bill** — hisobni o‘z zimmasiga olmoq

≈ **treat someone to a meal** — kimnidir mehmon qilmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

(fe’l) olmoq, yig‘moq, ko‘tarmoq — I need to **pick up** some bread on my way home.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Norasmiy, ko‘pincha amerikacha ibora: pick up the tab/bill. Mehmondo‘stlik madaniyatini gapirganda juda mos. ‘It’s on me’ ham ayting.

Namuna gap: In our culture, it’s normal for the oldest person to **pick up the tab**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

26 leave a tip

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

choy-chaqa qoldirmoq • *to give extra money to the waiter*

BAND 8 STORY

I always **leave a tip** if the waiter has been friendly, even a small one. Many staff in Tashkent earn little, so a few extra thousand som can make their evening.

≈ **tip the waiter** — ofitsiantga choychaqa bermoq

≈ **leave something extra** — qo‘shimcha qoldirmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

(ot) maslahat, ko‘rsatma — My teacher gave me a useful **tip** about how to answer Part 2.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Choy-chaqa haqida gapirganda: leave a tip (for + kim), a 10% tip. Odatda ofitsiant uchun. ‘Give tip’ demang, to‘g‘risi ‘leave a tip’ yoki ‘tip someone’.

Namuna gap: It’s polite to **leave a tip** when the service has been excellent.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

27 cater for dietary requirements

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

maxsus parhez talablarini hisobga olmoq • *to provide food suitable for people with special needs*

BAND 8 STORY

The restaurant **caters for dietary requirements**, so my vegetarian friend had plenty to choose from. She even got a gluten-free dessert, which made her feel properly included.

≈ **accommodate allergies** — allergiyani hisobga olmoq

≈ **offer vegan options** — vegan variantlar taklif qilmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO

(fe'l) tadbirga ovqat yetkazib bermoq — A local company **caters** for weddings across the city.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Allergiya, vegetarian, halol kabi talablarni hisobga olishni bildiradi: cater for/to. Zamonaviy restoranlar haqida gapirganda juda foydali.

Namuna gap: Good restaurants **cater for dietary requirements** without making a fuss.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

28 set menu

5/10 SPEAKING BALL

belgilangan to'plam menyu • *a fixed meal with several dishes at one price*

BAND 8 STORY

We chose the **set menu**, which included soup, a main course, and dessert for a fixed price. It saved us from endless decision-making, and the price was so reasonable that we added a pot of tea.

≈ **fixed-price menu** — narxi belgilangan menyu

≈ **tasting menu** — ta'mlarni sinash menyusi

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO

(sifat) belgilangan, qat'iy — We had a **set** time to finish the meal before the next group arrived.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Narxi belgilangan, bir necha taomli menyuni bildiradi: a three-course set menu. Qarama-qarshisi 'à la carte'. Business lunch haqida gapirganda ham mos.

Namuna gap: Many places offer a **set menu** at lunchtime, which is great value.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

29 be spoilt for choice

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

tanlovga to'lib-toshgan bo'lmoq • *to have so many good options that choosing is difficult*

BAND 8 STORY

At the food court, you're truly **spoilt for choice**: noodles, kebabs, pizza and sushi are all within a few metres. I spent ten minutes wandering around before finally settling on a bowl of lagman.

≈ **have plenty of options** — tanlov ko'p bo'lmoq

≈ **a wide range of** — keng tanlov

Qachon ishlatiladi: Variantlar ko'pligini ijobiy ma'noda ifodalaydi: be spoilt for choice (AmE: spoiled). Menyu, bozor yoki do'konlarni tasvirlashda juda mos.

Namuna gap: In Tashkent you're **spoilt for choice** when it comes to places to eat.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

30 dig in

6/10
SPEAKING BALL

yeyishni boshlamoq • *to start eating, usually eagerly*

BAND 8 STORY

When the plov finally arrived, the host smiled and told us to **dig in**. We didn't need telling twice, and within minutes the plate was half empty.

≈ **tuck in** — ishtaha bilan yeyishga kirishmoq

≈ **help yourself** — o'zingiz oling

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO

(fe'l) o'z fikrida turib olmoq; chuqurroq o'rganmoq — The manager **dug in** and refused to change the menu.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Norasmiy: mezbon mehmonlarga 'Dig in!' deydi. Do'stlar yoki oila davrasida ishlating, rasmiy vaziyatda emas. 'Dig into + taom' ham bor.

Namuna gap: As soon as the food hit the table, everyone **dug in** hungrily.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

31 treat myself to

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

o'zimni ... bilan erkalamoq • *to buy or do something special for yourself as a reward*

BAND 8 STORY
After finishing my exam, I decided to **treat myself to** a big dinner at my favourite restaurant. It felt like a well-deserved reward after months of stress.

≈ **indulge myself in** — o'zimga yoqimli narsa qilishga ruxsat bermoq

≈ **reward myself with** — o'zimni mukofotlamoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO
(fe'l) muomala qilmoq, davolamoq — The doctor said the infection can be **treated** with simple medicine.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Maxsus yutuq yoki charchoqdan keyin o'zingizni erkalash haqida: treat yourself to + noun. Part 2 da 'why you go there' sababi sifatida yaxshi.

Namuna gap: Sometimes I **treat myself to** a nice meal just to unwind.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

32 catch up over a meal

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ovqat ustida suhbatlashib, yangiliklarni bilmoq • *to talk about recent news with someone while eating*

BAND 8 STORY
Whenever my old classmates come to town, we **catch up over a meal** at the same little restaurant. We usually talk for three hours and forget the food is getting cold.

≈ **chat over dinner** — kechki ovqat ustida gaplashmoq

≈ **get together for a bite** — ovqat uchun yig'ilmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO
(fe'l) orqada qolmasdan yetib olmoq — I had to work hard to **catch up** with the rest of the class.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Do'stlar bilan uchrashuv haqida: catch up (with someone) over lunch/dinner/coffee. Part 2 da 'who you go with' bandida juda tabiiy.

Namuna gap: Restaurants are perfect places to **catch up over a meal** with old friends.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

33 celebrate a special occasion

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

maxsus voqeani nishonlamoq • *to mark an important event with a party or meal*

BAND 8 STORY
We usually **celebrate a special occasion** at a restaurant, whether it's a birthday or a graduation. This year, my parents booked a long table so the whole family could be there, and the evening was unforgettable.

≈ **mark a milestone** — muhim voqeani nishonlamoq

≈ **have a party for** — bazm uyushtirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Tug'ilgan kun, to'y yoki bitiruv kabi bayramlarni gapirganda: celebrate a special occasion/anniversary. Part 2 da restoranga borish sababini tushuntiradi.

Namuna gap: People often choose restaurants to **celebrate a special occasion** because there's no cleaning up.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

34 worth every penny

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

har bir tiyiniga arziydi • *so good that the price feels completely fair*

BAND 8 STORY

The meal wasn't cheap, but it was **worth every penny**. The food was amazing, the staff were kind, and I walked out feeling it was the best evening I'd had in months.

≈ **money well spent** — pul behuda ketmadi

≈ **good value for money** — puliga arziydi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Pul sarflaganingizdan mamnun ekaningizni bildirish uchun: It was worth every penny. Part 2 da 'why I like it' qismida yaxshi yakun bo'ladi.

Namuna gap: Their lamb is expensive, but honestly it's **worth every penny**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

35 value for money

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

puliga arzigulik • *when you get good quality for the price you pay*

BAND 8 STORY

We went there because it offers excellent **value for money**. For about the price of a coffee in a fancy café, you get a hearty three-course meal, and students like us can't ask for more.

≈ **a bargain** — arzon va yaxshi

≈ **reasonably priced** — narxi o'rtacha

Qachon ishlatiladi: Arzon va sifatli joyni tavsiflashda: good/great value for money. Talabalar uchun tabiiy sabab; 'cheap' so'zidan ko'ra ancha yaxshi, chunki 'cheap' sifatsiz degan ma'no berishi mumkin.

Namuna gap: Students look for **value for money** rather than the cheapest place.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

36 tuck into

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

ishtaha bilan yeb olmoq • *to eat something with great enjoyment*

BAND 8 STORY

The moment the plov hit the table, everyone **tucked into** it as if we hadn't eaten for days. My grandfather even said it was the best he'd had since our last family wedding.

≈ **dig into** — yeyishga kirishmoq

≈ **wolf down** — shosha-pisha yeb qo'ymoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO

(fe'l) to'shakka yotqizib yopmoq — She **tucked** her little brother **in** and turned off the light.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Britancha norasmiy fe'l: tuck into + taom. Mazali ovqatni ishtaha bilan yeyishni bildiradi. Part 2 da jonli kayfiyat qo'shadi.

Namuna gap: We all **tucked into** the meal with great enthusiasm.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

37 lose track of time

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

vaqtni sezmay qolmoq • *to be so involved that you forget how long has passed*

BAND 8 STORY

Whenever I'm there with my friends, I always **lose track of time**. Last time, we arrived at six for a quick dinner and left after ten, because the conversation never stopped.

≈ **time flies** — vaqt uchib o'tadi

≈ **be lost in conversation** — suhbatga berilib ketmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Zavq olib, soatlar o'tganini sezmay qolishni ifodalaydi: lose track of time. Part 2 da 'how I feel' yoki 'why I like it' qismida juda foydali.

Namuna gap: We often **lose track of time** when the conversation gets lively.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

38 a home away from home

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

uydek tuyuladigan joy • *a place where you feel as comfortable as in your own house*

BAND 8 STORY

After a few visits, the café became **a home away from home** for me. The staff know my order by heart, and the owner always asks about my studies like a family friend.

≈ **a second home** — ikkinchi uy

≈ **feel at home** — o'zini uyidagidek his qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Tez-tez boradigan, samimiy joyni tasvirlashda: a home away from home. Ma'no jihatidan 'second home' ga yaqin. Part 2 yakunida ajoyib ibora.

Namuna gap: For many students, a cosy café is **a home away from home**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

39 keep coming back

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

qayta-qayta kelaveradi • *to return again and again because you like a place*

BAND 8 STORY

The owner remembers everyone's name, and that's why customers **keep coming back**. I've been there at least twenty times, and each visit still feels fresh.

≈ **be a regular** — doimiy mijoz bo'lmoq

≈ **return time after time** — qayta-qayta qaytmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Doimiy mijozlar yoki sevimli joyga qaytishni bildiradi: keep + -ing. 'Keep coming back for more' iborasi ham mashhur.

Namuna gap: Great food is not enough to make customers **keep coming back**, since service matters too.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

40 grab a quick bite

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

tez yengil ovqat yeb olmoq • *to eat something small and fast*

BAND 8 STORY

Between classes I often **grab a quick bite** at a small café near the metro. It's not fancy, but a hot samsa and tea give me enough energy to get through the afternoon.

≈ **have a snack** — yengil tamaddi qilmoq

≈ **grab something to eat** — biror narsa yeb olmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO

(fe'l) diqqatni tortmoq — The headline **grabbed** my attention at once.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Vaqt kam bo'lganda tez ovqatlanishni aytishda: grab a (quick) bite (to eat). Norasmiy, Part 1 uchun juda mos. 'Eat a bite' demang.

Namuna gap: When I'm in a rush, I just **grab a quick bite** and carry on.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Part 3: eating habits, fast food and health

COLLOCATIONS 5 / 5

41 fast-food chain

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

tez ovqat tarmog‘i • *a company with many restaurants selling quick, cheap meals*

BAND 8 STORY

In recent years, a new **fast-food chain** has opened on almost every main street in Tashkent. Young people love them because the food is cheap and ready within minutes, although I worry about what it’s doing to our health.

≈ **burger joint** — burger do‘koni

≈ **quick-service restaurant** — tez xizmat qiluvchi restoran

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 da fast food haqidagi savollarga javob uchun asosiy ibora: a fast-food chain/outlet. Mashhur sabablar: cheap, convenient, tasty.

Namuna gap: Many people turn to a **fast-food chain** because it’s quick and cheap.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

42 convenience food

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

tayyor, oson tayyorlanadigan ovqat • *food that is quick and easy to prepare or buy*

BAND 8 STORY

With busy work schedules, **convenience food** is the easy option for many families. My neighbour says she has no energy to cook after ten hours at the office, and I honestly don’t blame her.

≈ **ready-made meals** — tayyor taomlar

≈ **instant meals** — darhol tayyor taomlar

Qachon ishlatiladi: Vaqt tanqisligi tufayli tayyor ovqatga murojaat qilish haqida: rely on convenience food. Part 3 dagi ‘Why is fast food so popular?’ ga yaxshi javob.

Namuna gap: The rise of **convenience food** reflects how little free time people have.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

43 processed food

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

qayta ishlangan ovqat • *food changed by factories, often with added sugar, salt or chemicals*

BAND 8 STORY

My doctor advised me to cut back on **processed food** after a routine check-up. It was hard at first, but when I started cooking with fresh vegetables, I noticed I had more energy.

≈ **junk food** — sifatsiz tez ovqat

≈ **ultra-processed products** — chuqur qayta ishlangan mahsulotlar

Qachon ishlatiladi: Sog‘liq muhokamasida (Part 3) ishlatiladi: eat/avoid/rely on processed food. Salbiy ohangdagi ibora; ‘unhealthy food’ dan ancha aniq.

Namuna gap: Too much **processed food** has been linked to obesity and heart disease.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

44 a balanced diet

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

muvozanatli ovqatlanish • *eating a healthy mix of different foods*

BAND 8 STORY

Since I started university, I've tried to follow **a balanced diet**, with vegetables, protein and fruit every day. It wasn't easy among all the exam stress, but I feel much more focused now.

≈ **a healthy diet** — sog'lom ovqatlanish

≈ **a nutritious diet** — to'yimli ovqatlanish

Qachon ishlatiladi: Sog'lom ovqatlanish haqida eng ko'p ishlatiladigan ibora: maintain/follow a balanced diet. Part 3 da 'home cooking healthier?' savoliga mos.

Namuna gap: Home cooking makes it easier to maintain **a balanced diet**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

45 eating habits

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ovqatlanish odatlari • *the usual ways in which a person or group eats*

BAND 8 STORY

Over the last decade, people's **eating habits** have changed a lot. My grandparents ate three home-cooked meals at the table, while my generation often skips breakfast and snacks on the go.

≈ **dietary patterns** — ovqatlanish tartibi

≈ **food culture** — oziq-ovqat madaniyati

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 dagi 'Are people's eating habits changing?' savoliga to'g'ridan-to'g'ri mos. 'Habits' ko'plikda ishlatiladi; 'eating habit' yakkama bo'lsa ham mumkin.

Namuna gap: Changes in **eating habits** are closely linked to busier lifestyles.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

46 health-conscious

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

sog'lig'iga e'tiborli • *caring about your health and choosing food carefully*

BAND 8 STORY

More young people are becoming **health-conscious** these days. My cousin, for example, reads every label, goes to the gym four times a week, and now orders grilled fish instead of fries.

≈ **health-minded** — sog'lig'ini o'ylaydigan

≈ **careful about what they eat** — nima yeyishiga ehtiyot

Qachon ishlatiladi: Sog'lom turmush tarziga e'tibor beradigan odamlarni tasvirlaydi: health-conscious consumers/diners. Part 3 trendlari uchun juda foydali.

Namuna gap: **Health-conscious** customers are pushing restaurants to offer lighter dishes.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

47 cut down on

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

kamaytirmoq • *to reduce the amount of something you eat or do*

BAND 8 STORY

My dentist told me to **cut down on** sugar, so I swapped fizzy drinks for green tea. It was tough for the first week, but now I don't even miss them.

≈ **cut back on** — qisqartirmoq

≈ **reduce my intake of** — iste'molimni kamaytirmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO

(fe'l) kesib tashlamoq (daraxt) — They had to **cut down** the old tree before the storm.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Zararli narsalarni kamaytirishni bildiradi: cut down on + noun (sugar, salt, fast food). 'Cut down' dan keyin 'on' ni unutmang. Part 1 va 3 da foydali.

Namuna gap: Doctors urge people to **cut down on** salt and sugar.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

48 opt for

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

tanlamoq • *to choose one option instead of another*

BAND 8 STORY

When I'm in a hurry, I usually **opt for** a salad rather than something heavy. It keeps me light and focused, and I don't feel sleepy during afternoon lessons.

≈ **go for** — tanlamoq

≈ **settle on** — bir qarorga kelmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ikki variant orasida tanlovni ifodalaydi: opt for + noun / opt to + verb. 'Choose' dan ko'ra rasmiyroq va tabiiyroq. Part 1 va 3 da foydali.

Namuna gap: Many diners now **opt for** healthier options instead of heavy fried dishes.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

49 food delivery apps

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ovqat yetkazib berish ilovalari • *mobile apps for ordering meals to your home*

BAND 8 STORY

Food delivery apps have changed the way my friends eat. On rainy evenings, they order dinner with two taps and it arrives at the door, which is wonderfully convenient but a bit too easy to rely on.

≈ **takeaway apps** — olib ketish ilovalari

≈ **online ordering** — onlayn buyurtma

Qachon ishlatiladi: Zamonaviy ovqatlanish tendensiyalari haqida: rely on/use food delivery apps. Part 3 da 'Are eating habits changing?' ga yaxshi dalil.

Namuna gap: The popularity of **food delivery apps** has made restaurants rethink their business.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

50 put on weight

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

semirib ketmoq • *to become heavier, usually by eating too much*

BAND 8 STORY

When I started working long hours, I **put on weight** because I ate late at night. It took me several months of walking and cooking at home to get back in shape.

≈ **gain weight** — vazn orttirmoq

≈ **pile on the pounds** — vazn tez ko‘paymoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

(fe’l) kiyib ko‘rmoq, kiymoq (kiyim, bilan) — I **put on** my coat and headed to the restaurant.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ovqatlanish oqibatlarini aytishda: put on weight/pounds/kilos. Qarama-qarshisi ‘lose weight’. ‘Increase weight’ demang.

Namuna gap: Eating fast food regularly can make you **put on weight** quickly.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Describe and explain

STRUCTURES 1 / 2

1 What I love most about ... is that ...

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

Menga ... ning eng yoqadigani shuki ... • *a cleft pattern that puts the main point at the end for emphasis*

BAND 8 STORY

What I love most about that restaurant **is that** nothing feels rushed. The waiters let us talk for hours, and we never feel pushed to leave.

≈ **What I appreciate is ...** — Men qadrlaydigan narsa shuki ...

≈ **The thing I like best is ...** — Menga eng yoqqani shuki ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 2 da asosiy sababni kuchli ta'kidlashda ishlating. 'What' dan keyin o'zingiz, 'is' dan keyin gap yoki 'to + fe'l'. Bu strukturani 2 martadan ortiq ishlatmang.

Namuna gap: **What I love most about** eating out **is that** I don't have to wash the dishes afterwards.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 It was ... that ...

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

... aynan shu edi ki ... • *a cleft pattern that stresses one part of the sentence*

BAND 8 STORY

It was the smell of fresh bread **that** first drew me into the restaurant. I'd only wanted to walk past, but my stomach decided otherwise, and I've been a regular ever since.

≈ **It's ... who/that ...** — Aynan ... dir ki ...

≈ **What ... was ...** — Narsa ... edi

Qachon ishlatiladi: O'tgan voqeada muhim qismni ajratib ko'rsatish uchun. Ikkinchi qismda 'that' (narsa) yoki 'who' (odam) ishlating. Part 2 hikoyasida juda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: **It was** the warm service **that** made the evening so special.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 The more ..., the more ...

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

Qanchalik ... bo'lsa, shunchalik ... • *a double comparative showing two things increase together*

BAND 8 STORY

The more I went there, **the more** I fell in love with the food. By my fifth visit, the chef was recommending dishes I'd never have ordered myself.

≈ **The longer ..., the better ...** — Qancha uzoq bo'lsa, shuncha yaxshi

≈ **As ..., so ...** — ... bilan birga ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ikki o'zgarish bog'liq ekanini ko'rsatadi. Har ikki qismda 'the + qiyosiy daraja' bo'lishi kerak. Part 3 da trend tasvirlashga ham mos.

Namuna gap: **The more** people work, **the less** time they have for cooking at home.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 so + adj + that / such + noun + that

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

shu qadar ... ki ... • *used to explain a result of an extreme quality*

BAND 8 STORY

The dessert was **so** rich **that** we had to share one portion between three of us. It was **such** a memorable evening **that** we still joke about it.

≈ **to the extent that ...** — shu darajadaki ...

≈ **so much so that ...** — shunchalik ... ki ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Natijani kuchaytirish uchun: so + sifat; such + (a) + sifat + ot. Part 2 da his-tuyg'uni tasvirlashda yaxshi. 'Such' dan keyin ot bo'ladi.

Namuna gap: The portions were **so** generous **that** nobody could finish dessert.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 the place in which / where ...

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

... bo'lgan joy • *a relative clause with a preposition to describe a place*

BAND 8 STORY

It's the sort of place **in which** you can relax completely. I discovered it with my cousin, and it's **where** I celebrated my birthday last year.

≈ **the restaurant at which ...** — ... joyda

≈ **the café where ...** — ... kafe, u yerda

Qachon ishlatiladi: Joyni tasvirlashda rasmiy uslub: the place in which / at which. Preposition 'which' oldida turadi (in which); norasmiy 'the place where' ham yaxshi.

Namuna gap: This is the café **in which** we first discussed our plans.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 Not only does ..., but ... also ...

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

... nafaqat ..., balki ... ham • *an inversion that adds two good points with emphasis*

BAND 8 STORY

Not only does the restaurant serve delicious food, **but** it **also** has a lovely view of the river. That's why I recommend it to everyone who visits Tashkent.

≈ **As well as -ing, ...** — ... bilan bir qatorda ...

≈ **Besides being ..., it is also ...** — ... bo'lishidan tashqari ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ikkita ijobiy sababni kuchli qilib aytish. 'Not only' dan keyin yordamchi fe'l oldinga chiqadi: does the restaurant serve... Part 2 sabablarida juda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: **Not only does** home cooking save money, **but** it **also** allows you to control what you eat.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

7 Hardly had I + p.p. when ...

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

... ulgurmayoq, ... • *an inversion meaning one thing happened right after another*

BAND 8 STORY

Hardly had we sat down **when** the waiter brought a pot of hot tea and fresh bread. I was starving after a long day, so I almost cried with joy.

≈ **No sooner had ... than ...** — ... bilan ... bir vaqtda

≈ **As soon as ...** — ... bilan ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ketma-ket ikki voqeani hikoyada dramatik ifodalash. Hardly + had + ega + p.p. + when + o'tgan zamon. Faqat Part 2 hikoyasi uchun; kundalik suhbatda kam.

Namuna gap: **Hardly had** I finished my meal **when** the next group arrived.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 Having + p.p., S + V

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

... qilgandan keyin, ... • *a participle clause showing one action finished before another*

BAND 8 STORY

Having tried most places in the neighbourhood, I can say this restaurant is the best. It beats the others for flavour, atmosphere and price.

≈ **After + -ing, ...** — ... dan keyin ...

≈ **Once I had ..., I ...** — ... qilgach, ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Oldingi ish tugagani va undan keyingi xulosa haqida. Ikkala gapning egasi bir xil bo'lishi kerak (I ... I). Part 2 va 3 uchun tabiiy.

Namuna gap: **Having** worked in a kitchen, I appreciate how hard chefs work.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 If it weren't for ..., I wouldn't ...

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

Agar ... bo'lmaganda, men ... bo'lmasdim • *a conditional that says what would happen without something*

BAND 8 STORY

If it weren't for that little café, I wouldn't have met my best friend. We were both waiting for the same table, and ended up sharing one.

≈ **Were it not for ...** — ... bo'lmaganda

≈ **But for ...** — ... bo'lmasa

Qachon ishlatiladi: Hozirgi yoki umumiy natijani 'agar bu bo'lmaganda' tarzida aytish. If it weren't for + ot; yoki 'Were it not for' (rasmiyroq). Part 2 'why it's important' uchun mos.

Namuna gap: **If it weren't for** delivery apps, many families would cook more.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 I wish / If only + past perfect

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

Qani endi ... bo‘lganda edi • *expresses regret about a past situation*

BAND 8 STORY

I **wish** I **had** known about that restaurant earlier. **If only** I **had** booked a table, I wouldn’t have waited an hour outside in the cold.

≈ **I regret not -ing ...** — ... qilmaganimdan afsusdaman

≈ **It’s a pity that I didn’t ...** — ... qilmaganim afsus

Qachon ishlatiladi: O‘tmishdagi afsus. Wish + had + p.p. Kelajakdagi istak uchun ‘would’ ishlatiladi. Part 2 da ‘how I felt’ qismida ham mos.

Namuna gap: I **wish** I **had** learned to cook before moving to the dormitory.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 Little did I know ...

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

... ekanini bilmagan edim • *an inversion for a surprise in a story*

BAND 8 STORY

Little did I know that the quiet café would change my whole routine. A friend dragged me there for a quick coffee, and I ended up studying there every weekend for two years.

≈ **I had no idea that ...** — ... ekanini xayolimga ham keltirmagan edim

≈ **Never did I imagine ...** — ... deb o‘ylamagan edim

Qachon ishlatiladi: Hikoyadagi kutilmagan burilishni bildiradi. Little did + ega + fe’l (asosiy shakl). Faqat o‘tgan zamon voqealari uchun. Part 2 da effektli.

Namuna gap: **Little did I know** that one dinner would lead to a new hobby.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 It is widely believed that ...

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

... deb keng tarqalgan ishonch bor • *a passive reporting structure for general opinions*

BAND 8 STORY

It is widely believed that home cooking is healthier than eating out. However, I’d argue that it depends on what you cook, because a heavy home meal can be just as unhealthy.

≈ **It is often said that ...** — Ko‘pincha ... deyishadi

≈ **... is generally regarded as ...** — ... deb hisoblanadi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 da umumiy fikrni ob’ektiv aytib, keyin o‘z fikringizni qo‘shish uchun. ‘It is said/believed/claimed that’ shakllari ham bor. ‘However, I think...’ bilan davom eting.

Namuna gap: **It is widely believed that** fast food is the main cause of obesity.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

SAMPLE CUE CARD

Describe a restaurant you like.

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You should say:

- where it is
- what food it serves
- who you go with
- why you like it

My 1-minute notes

- Chinor • behind old bazaar • near university
- manti • plov • generous portions • fresh
- friends • cousins • parents • anniversary
- laid-back • courtyard • lose track of time
- local ingredients • fair prices • value for money
- home away from home • keep coming back

SAMPLE ANSWER • BAND 8

I • Intro (what, where)	I'd like to talk about a family-run restaurant called Chinor, which is tucked away behind the old bazaar in Tashkent. It's within walking distance of my university, and I first found it by accident when I was looking for somewhere quiet to study.
P • What food it serves	As for the food, they specialise in authentic Uzbek cuisine. Their signature dish is a lamb dumpling called manti, which is so tender that it practically melts in your mouth. The portions are generous, everything is freshly prepared, and the plov is cooked to perfection every Thursday.
P • Who you go with	When it comes to who I go with, it's usually my close friends or my cousins. Having grown up together, we use the restaurant to catch up over a meal at least once a month. Occasionally, I take my parents there to celebrate a special occasion, like their anniversary.
E • Reason 1	The first reason I like it is the laid-back atmosphere. What I love most about the place is that nobody ever rushes you, so we often lose track of time and stay for hours, chatting under the vine leaves in the courtyard.
E • Reason 2	On top of that, it offers excellent value for money. Not only does the owner use locally sourced ingredients, but he also keeps prices fair for students. A full meal for three of us costs less than a fast-food combo, and it's worth every penny.
W • Wrap-up	So, all in all, Chinor is a home away from home for me. If it weren't for that little place, I wouldn't have discovered how much a warm meal can change your mood, and that's why I keep coming back.

UPGRADE YOUR TALK

Tell a story, not a list

Instead of…	Say…
a nice restaurant	a hidden gem / a cosy little place
very tasty	mouth-watering / packed with flavour
big portions	generous portions
cheap	good value for money
good service	attentive service
pay for everyone	pick up the tab
eat quickly	grab a quick bite
run by a family	family-run
a relaxed place	a laid-back atmosphere
always full of people	always packed
full of life	buzzing with life
nicely decorated	tastefully decorated
soft, dark light	dimly lit
tables outside	outdoor seating
cooked very well	cooked to perfection
very soft and tasty	melt in your mouth
very hot	piping hot
from nearby farms	locally sourced
real traditional food	authentic cuisine
made fresh	freshly prepared
share the bill	split the bill
give extra money to the waiter	leave a tip
start eating	dig in
too many choices	spoilt for choice
healthy diet	a balanced diet